

30 years by making that particular match carbon neutral by 2052.

Now consider the scale of the cricket World Cup. It involves extensive travel for teams, support staff, and fans, both from other countries, and from within India. Moreover, most matches require floodlights. Additionally, the event entails complex logistics and will generate substantial waste in the form of water, food and plastics. Plus, millions of viewers will tune in to watch and stream these matches on devices like TVs, mobile phones, and laptops. Taken together, the resultant footprint becomes exceedingly significant.

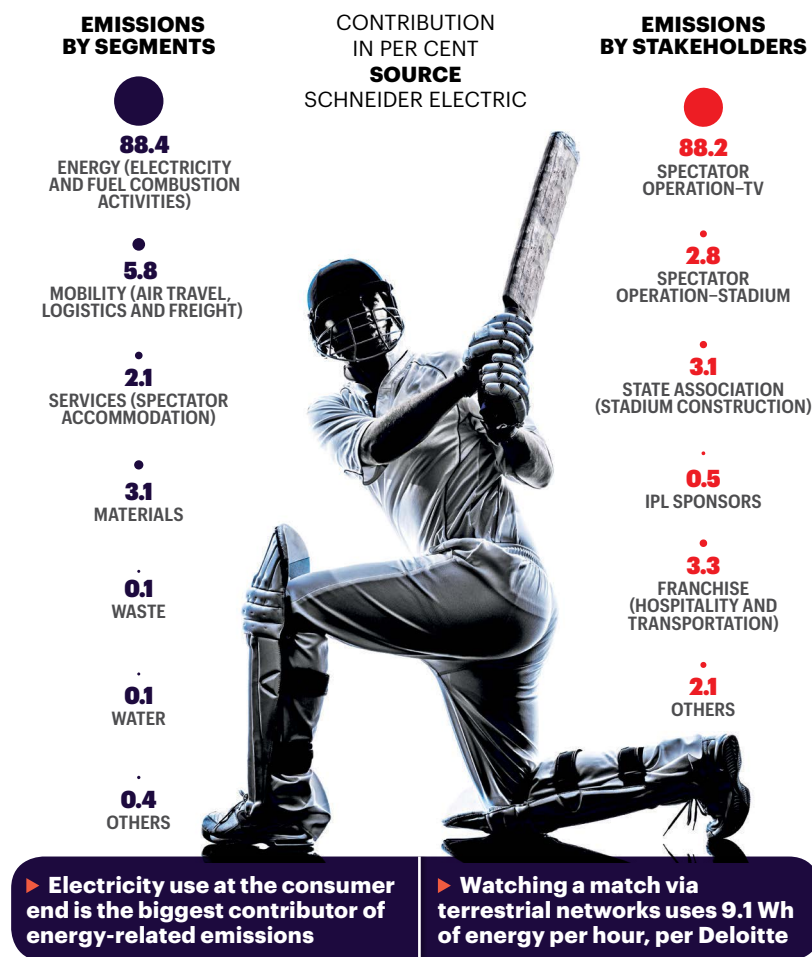
The International Cricket Council (ICC), the global governing body of cricket, is aware of this. Its spokesperson tells *Business Today*, “The ICC is still developing a global sustainability strategy for the sport, and as a part of that, it undertook a carbon footprint audit of the ICC Men’s T20 World Cup 2022 and will do the same for the ICC Men’s Cricket World Cup 2023 so we can understand the environmental impact of our events and have a baseline from which to work in reducing our footprint.”

It says a number of sustainability initiatives are ongoing. “This includes plastic recycling machines being installed at every venue, which will see the waste turned into ICC staff clothing for future events. There is a waste management project in partnership with Coca-Cola and United Way Mumbai, which includes waste segregation and reducing landfills,” the ICC spokesperson explains.

Some of the ICC’s official partners, too, have announced sustainability measures. Travel booking portal Booking.com, the official accommodation partner for

CO₂ EMISSIONS OF ONE CRICKET MATCH

AN ESTIMATED 10,000 TONNES OF CO₂ WERE RELEASED INTO THE ATMOSPHERE DURING A T20 MATCH IN MAY OF 2022



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A three-pillar approach can be taken to decarbonise the tournament—strategise, digitise, and decarbonise—say experts. This could include measures like reducing the use of electricity, fuel, water, etc.